



Extensions, Part 2

This is a continuation of the article 'Enrich OpenOffice.org with Extensions' published last month.

In the previous article, we have looked at how to develop two types of extensions—add-ons and add-ins. This time we'll discuss the remaining two extensions—client applications and UNO components—in addition to more discussions on UNO, a component model used for programmability.

Client applications

A client application is a stand-alone J2SE application that can bootstrap a UNO environment and start the default OpenOffice.org, or connect to a running instance. A client application project is nothing but a standard Java project with an added OpenOffice.org library. As APIs are integrated into NetBeans, features like code completion, error highlighting, the automatic import of packages, etc, are available.

Creating a client application is a straightforward *File→New Project→OpenOffice.org→OpenOffice.org Client Application*. In the next screen, fill in a project name, say *SimpleClient*, and a suitable package name like *org.lfy.example*. That's it! Your client application project has been successfully set up.

Now go to 'Project explorer' and open the code for the main method in *SimpleClient.java*: *SimpleClient→Source Packages→org.lfy.example→SimpleClient.java*.

A default code to bootstrap office instance is presented in the main method. Replace that with the following code, which is used to load a new Calc document when this client application is run.

```
try {  
    XComponentContext xContext = Bootstrap.  
        bootstrap();
```